CYENCE rules

Version 1.1, updated on October 17th 2026

This document is a preliminary version of the CYENCE Rules and is subject to minor revisions before its final publication.

1. General Provisions

CYENCE – Czech Youth Expo & Conference is an international science competition and conference for young researchers organized by the **Brno Observatory and Planetarium** and **Zvaž vědu!, z. s.**, held under the auspices of the **Ministry of Education, Youth and Sports of the Czech Republic**.

The purpose of CYENCE is to bring together outstanding young researchers from different countries, provide them with an opportunity to present and discuss their research, and encourage international scientific collaboration.

The official language of CYENCE is **English**. All competition materials and presentations must therefore be prepared in English.

CYENCE 2027 will take place in the Czech Republic from **5 - 11 September 2027** (arrivals possible from September 4, departures possible from September 12), with the main programme based in **Brno**.

For the purposes of these Rules, the **CYENCE Executive Committee** is the body responsible for the organisation and supervision of CYENCE. It consists of the Minister of Education, Youth and Sports of the Czech Republic, the Director of the Brno Observatory and Planetarium, and the Chairman of Zvaž vědu!, z. s. They may authorize other representatives of their respective institutions to participate in the commission. The CYENCE Executive Committee will appoint the CYENCE Organizing Committee, which will be responsible for specific tasks related to the organization of the event.

2. Eligibility

Participants must be **at least 15 years old** and **have not reached age 21** on September 12th 2027.

Participants must have been **secondary/high school students** at the time the **submitted project was carried out**.

Participants who have **already completed their first year of university-level study** are not eligible to compete.

International participants are nominated by a recognized national or regional science competition, fair, or other organization approved by the CYENCE Executive Committee.

Eligible nominating organizations are contacted and invited directly by the CYENCE Executive Committee, the Ministry of Education, Youth and Sports of the Czech Republic, or CYENCE partner organizations, such as MILSET. Other organizations may request special approval from the CYENCE Executive Committee.

Each **country** may nominate a **maximum of three students** and a **maximum of three projects** in total.

The CYENCE Executive Committee reserves the right to **adjust the maximum number of participants** or projects permitted from an individual country where justified by organizational, capacity or representation considerations.

Participation is possible with either an individual project or a team project. A **team** may consist of a **maximum of three students**.

Each participant may compete with only **one project** and may be listed as a member of only one competing team.

Each national delegation may include **one registered delegation leader**, whose participation is covered under the standard CYENCE participation conditions. Additional delegation leaders may be accepted as visitors, **subject to prior approval** by the CYENCE Executive Committee and payment of an additional participation fee.The amount of this fee and the applicable conditions will be communicated separately before the event.

A participant may represent a country at CYENCE only if they **hold a valid passport issued by that country**. Participants holding multiple nationalities may represent any country whose valid passport they hold, but may represent only one country at CYENCE.

The CYENCE Executive Committee reserves the right to approve nominations and determine the final eligibility of participants and projects.

3. Eligible Projects

CYENCE accepts original research and engineering projects from fields of **science, technology, engineering** and **mathematics**, specified in the list of categories. (see appendix)

If it is unclear whether a project falls within one of the listed categories, participants or nominating organizations may contact the CYENCE Organizing Committee for clarification prior to submission.

A project should demonstrate the participant's own substantial intellectual and practical contribution. Projects consisting solely of a literature review, presentation of established scientific knowledge, or demonstration of an existing technology without an original research or development component are not eligible.

Research conducted in cooperation with a university, research institution, company or scientific mentor is welcome. However, participants must **clearly identify their own contribution to the project** and distinguish it from work performed by supervisors, mentors or other researchers.

4. Scientific Integrity

All participants are expected to follow internationally recognized principles of responsible research conduct.

Plagiarism, fabrication or falsification of data, intentional misrepresentation of results, or **presenting another person's work as one's own** is **prohibited**.

All sources, datasets, images, software and other external materials must be appropriately acknowledged. Contributions of mentors, laboratories, institutions and collaborators must also be disclosed.

Artificial intelligence tools may be used as supporting tools where appropriate, but their use must not replace the participant's own scientific contribution. Participants remain fully responsible for the accuracy, originality and integrity of all submitted and presented material.

Any serious violation of scientific integrity, **whether identified before the event or discovered at any time during CYENCE**, will result in the **immediate disqualification** of the participant or project from the competition.

5. Ethics and Safety

During the participation in CYENCE, all participants are required to comply with the **laws and regulations of the Czech Republic**.

Projects, posters, presentations and participant conduct must respect the **fundamental principles of human dignity, equality and non-discrimination**.

Content or behaviour that promotes or expresses racism, hatred, discrimination, violence, dehumanization, or serious violations of fundamental human rights is not permitted at CYENCE.

This applies both to **materials submitted or presented** as part of the competition and to the participant's **conduct throughout the event**.

Any serious violation of these principles, **whether identified before the event or during CYENCE**, may result in the **disqualification** of the participant or project from the competition and, where appropriate, **removal** of the participant from the CYENCE programme.

Any decision on disqualification or removal will be made by the CYENCE Executive Committee and communicated to the participant's registered **national delegation leader.**

The CYENCE Executive Committee reserves the right to reject a project, presentation or other content that is incompatible with these principles or with applicable Czech law.

Research presented at CYENCE must have been conducted responsibly, safely and in accordance with the **applicable laws, institutional requirements and ethical standards of the country in which the research was performed.**

Projects involving human participants, vertebrate animals, potentially hazardous biological agents, human or animal tissue, hazardous chemicals or other potentially dangerous procedures may be subject to additional review by the CYENCE Executive Committee.

Where ethical, institutional or regulatory approval was required for the research, participants must be able to provide evidence that the appropriate approval was obtained.

Research involving unnecessary harm to humans or animals, serious disregard for environmental safety, or activities prohibited by applicable law is not eligible for CYENCE.

The CYENCE Executive Committee may request additional documentation concerning the ethical or safe conduct of any project and may reject a project where adequate documentation cannot be provided.

6. Registration and Submission Requirements

Nominated participants must complete their registration and submit all required project forms, supporting documents and other materials requested by the CYENCE Executive Committee by **31st May**. If the rules of your national competition do not allow for the selection of projects by this deadline, or if you have another specific reason, you may request an extension until **30th June** from the CYENCE Organizing Committee.

The required **project documentation** includes:

- a **Project & Participant Form** containing basic information about the project, its authors, methodology, results and the participant's own contribution
- a **Research Institution & Supervisor Form**, where applicable, for projects carried out or supervised at a university, research institute, hospital, company or other professional research facility
- an **Ethics & Safety Declaration** identifying whether the project involves human participants, vertebrate animals, biological materials, hazardous substances or other potentially sensitive or hazardous research
- **Parental consent for participants under age of 18**
- for delegations from countries subject to a visa requirement, a **signet declaration confirming that all required visa and entry documents** will be arranged within the **applicable deadlines set by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Czech Republic**
- any additional approvals or supporting documentation requested by the CYENCE Executive Committee for projects involving specific ethical or safety considerations

The required **competition and programme** materials include:

- a **Quad Chart** summarising the submitted project
- an **abstract** of the submitted project
- the participant's **CYENCE Roadshow presentation**
- a **video presentation of the project**, with a maximum length of **5 minutes**

All of these materials must be submitted in advance and in accordance with the deadlines set by the CYENCE Executive Committee.

Detailed requirements regarding the content, format, length, technical specifications and submission method for the Quad Chart, abstract and Public Day presentation are provided in **an appendix**.

Participants are responsible for ensuring that all submitted information and documentation is complete and accurate by the applicable deadline. Late or incomplete submissions may result in the participant or project being excluded from the competition unless an exception has been approved by the CYENCE Executive Committee.

7. Project Poster Presentation

Participants will present their research in **English** during the CYENCE competition.

Each project will be presented through a **scientific poster** and an oral discussion with members of the jury. The detailed poster format, dimensions and technical requirements are provided in the Appendix.

Participants must be able to explain the research question, methodology, results, limitations and significance of their project, as well as clearly describe their own contribution. For team projects, all registered team members are expected to have a meaningful understanding of the project and to be able to explain their individual contribution.

Participants may also bring **physical objects, prototypes, models or other materials directly related to their project**, provided that these items are safe, lawful and suitable for use in the competition venue. Objects involving dangerous substances, hazardous biological material, open flames, weapons, high-risk devices or any other item that may endanger participants, visitors or property are not permitted.

Any physical materials brought to the competition must fit within the participant's designated presentation area and must be transportable and handled by the participant without requiring special equipment or assistance from the CYENCE Organizing Committee, unless otherwise approved in advance.

During the official judging session, each project will be visited by **at least one member of the jury**. The participant will first have up to **5 minutes** to present the project without interruption. This presentation should briefly explain the purpose of the project, the approach taken, the main results and the participant's own contribution.

After the initial presentation, the jury member may ask questions and discuss the project with the participant. Additional jury members may also visit the project during the judging session and may ask further questions or request clarification. The exact number of jury interactions may vary between projects.

The **CYENCE Executive Committee reserves the right to further specify the organisation of the poster session, judging procedure, presentation format and technical requirements before the competition**. Any such details will be communicated to participants in advance.

8. Judging Criteria and Awards

Projects will be evaluated by an international jury consisting of **researchers, academics and other experts**, primarily from Czech universities and research institutions.

Each competition category listed in the Appendix will be evaluated by a **separate jury**. Each category jury will normally consist of **3 - 6 members**. The overall judging process will be supervised by the **Chair of the Jury**, who is responsible for ensuring the proper, independent and academically fair conduct of the evaluation.

The jury will consider in particular:

- scientific quality and methodology
- originality and significance of the work
- quality and interpretation of the results
- the participant's own contribution and understanding of the project
- the ability to communicate and discuss the research

Decisions of the jury regarding competition results are **final**.
Awards will be granted separately within each competition category. The number of awards may vary depending on the number of projects in the category. As a general guideline:

- approximately the top **10 - 15%** of projects may receive a **First Award**
- approximately the next **15 - 30%** may receive a **Second Award**
- approximately the next **30 - 50%** may receive a **Third Award**

The exact number and distribution of awards may be adjusted by the CYENCE Executive Committee depending on the number and quality of projects in each category.

A **Public Choice Award** will also be presented. This award will be determined by votes from Czech high school students participating in the CYENCE public

programme, who will select the project they consider the most engaging or inspiring. Detailed voting procedures, eligibility conditions and other organizational arrangements for the Public Choice Award will be communicated before the competition.

Additional **special awards** may be presented by CYENCE partners or supporting institutions. The categories and conditions of these awards will be announced separately before the competition.

9. CYENCE Roadshow

All CYENCE finalists are expected to take part in the **CYENCE Roadshow**, a nationwide science outreach programme connecting international young researchers with Czech high school students.

During the Public Day, finalists will travel in smaller groups to selected cities across the Czech Republic, where they will present their competition projects directly to Czech high school students.

Each finalist will prepare an approximately **30-minute presentation** in English based on their CYENCE project. The presentation should introduce the topic, research question, methods, main results and significance of the project in a way that is understandable and engaging for a general high-school audience.

The CYENCE Roadshow presentation is **not intended to be a second scientific judging session**. Participants should therefore adapt their competition project into a more accessible and popular-science format. Technical terminology should be explained where necessary, and finalists are encouraged to use visual materials, examples, demonstrations or other suitable means of communication. Participants are also expected to include relevant **personal experiences** from their home country, such as their path into research, scientific competitions, educational opportunities or other experiences that may be useful and inspiring for Czech students.

Participation in the CYENCE Roadshow forms an **integral part of the CYENCE programme**, and finalists are expected to prepare and deliver their presentation unless otherwise agreed with the CYENCE Executive Committee.

Detailed requirements concerning the content, structure, length, format and technical specifications of the Roadshow presentation are provided in the Appendix

Before the event, participants will be offered a preparation session in which the purpose, expected format and practical organisation of the CYENCE Roadshow will be explained and participants will have an opportunity to ask questions.

10. Programme Attendance and Supervision

Participation in the **official CYENCE programme is mandatory** during the programme hours specified below, unless a participant has been excused in advance by the CYENCE Organizing Committee.

For CYENCE 2027, participants are required to be available for the official programme during the following times, if not said otherwise by the CYENCE Organizing Committee.

- 5th September: 16:00 - 19:00
- 6th September: 08:00 - 19:00
- 7th September: 08:00 - 12:00
- 8th September: 08:00 - 16:00
- 9th September: 04:00 - 21:00 (depends on the city where the participant is taking part in CYENCE Roadshow)
- 10th September: 08:00 - 13:00, 17:00 - 19:00
- 11th September: 13:00 - 16:00

These time periods include **competition activities**, the **Public Day**, organised **excursions**, official social activities, transportation and other parts of the CYENCE programme designated as mandatory by the CYENCE Executive Committee.

Where **free time** is scheduled after the end of the official programme, participation in any informal activities is **optional**. Participants are encouraged to spend this time in Brno together with their **designated guide** and may join informal activities organised or suggested by the guide, while following the supervision and safety requirements established by the CYENCE Executive Committee.

All participants must follow the instructions of CYENCE organizers, designated guides and delegation leaders throughout the event.

Participants **under the age of 18** must remain **under the supervision of an adult guide** or their **national delegation leader** when moving outside the official programme, unless the CYENCE Organizing Committee has explicitly approved another arrangement.

Participants must respect the times and meeting points communicated by the CYENCE Organizing Committee and must not leave an organised activity,

accommodation or designated meeting location without following the applicable supervision rules.

11. Participation Costs and Organizer Coverage

CYENCE participation is provided **without a participation fee**.

Participants and national delegations are responsible for arranging and covering the cost of their travel from their home country to one of the designated arrival airports: **Prague, Vienna or Bratislava**.

From these designated airports, the CYENCE Executive Committee will provide and cover official transfers to **Brno**.

The Executive Committee will also cover:

- accommodation during the official CYENCE programme
- breakfast during the stay
- selected meals and refreshments provided as part of the official programme, including receptions or catering during the Opening and Closing Ceremonies
- official transportation required during the CYENCE programme
- transfers connected with official programme activities

Any personal expenses, additional meals, private transportation or other costs not explicitly included in the official CYENCE programme are the responsibility of the participant or their delegation.

12. Conduct and Participation

Participants are expected to behave respectfully, responsibly and professionally throughout CYENCE.

Participants must **follow the instructions of the CYENCE Executive Committee**, **CYENCE Organizing Committee, designated guides, delegation leaders, venue staff** and other persons responsible for the organisation and safety of the event.

Participants must comply with the ethical, behavioural and presentation standards set out in **Section 5 – Ethics and Safety**.

Serious or repeated violations may result in removal from individual programme activities, disqualification from the competition or, in serious cases, removal from the CYENCE programme.

Participants are expected to treat accommodation, venues, equipment and other property used during CYENCE with due care.

In the event of **damage caused by a participant**, the registered **national delegation leader is responsible** for resolving the matter and, where applicable, for arranging compensation for the damage, unless otherwise agreed with the CYENCE Executive Committee or the affected party.

This does not prevent responsibility from being assigned directly to the participant where appropriate and mutually agreed.

By submitting the application, each participant confirms that they have read these Rules and agrees to comply with them throughout their participation in CYENCE.